



Cellphone Imaging

Who would have thought we'd ever see a day when cellphones would almost be on the verge of making the basic point and shoot camera obsolete? If you would have considered the idea even a year ago, it would have been ridiculous, but now, it's not so far-fetched. We're starting to see phones with many of the features found in a basic point and shoot camera and we're talking not just software, but also a lot of the hardware stuff as well. We're seeing optical image stabilization, bigger sensors, and incredible optics. To the untrained eye, images from an affordable point and shoot when compared to images from these cameras would seem no different (under adequate lighting conditions, of course).

Testing these camera phones has been nothing short of an adventure full of excitement and revelations. Each device has its advantages over the competition and the image obtained has a signature that can be considered to be unique to the said device. These camera phones are relatively still a little expensive, but if you do factor the economics of it all, it might make not just financial, but also ergonomic sense to just carry one device. If you are one of those who wants to replace their point and shoot with a cellphone, we've got quite a few suggestions for you, but only ONE that rules that roost.

Zero1 Winner

Nokia Lumia 1020

The Nokia Lumia 1020 is the culmination of Nokia's finest technological advancements. It combines a large, 0.66 inch, 41 megapixel sensor with an f/2.2 Zeiss-made lens. In case you're wondering, the sensor size in the Lumia 1020 is bigger than what you'd see in most point and shoot cameras, which is saying something. But it isn't just the hardware that's stellar, it's also the software Nokia's plugged into the 1020. The Nokia Pro Cam app gives the user complete control over every single aspect of creating an image such as white balance, shutter speed and even manual focus. The best part about the Lumia 1020 is that thanks to its incredibly large pixel count and a large sensor, it is able to take photos that are unrivalled by any camera phone in the market at the moment, and matches (if not better) most sub-20K point and shoot cameras. This is THE point and shoot replacement,



Sony Xperia Z1

Price: ₹42,990



LG G2

Price: ₹36,100

the one you've been asking for, the one you deserve especially considering the price at which this beauty comes in for.

Worthy Mentions

Sony Xperia Z1

This is Sony's point and shoot camera in an incredibly slim cellphone body. The Z1 is a 20 megapixel shooter with a more than adept 1/2.3 inch sensor right out of Sony's common point and shoot cameras. The camera brings many of Sony's scene modes to the cellphone, along with the ability to shoot in manual mode as well. The Z1 has secured the second spot in our testing by quite a leap, but remains somewhat behind the Lumia 1020. If you want a camera that's capable of going from sleep mode to firing off the first shot all in under a second! It is THAT FAST and we love it for that.

The LG G2

The LG G2 gets a worthy mention in the Zero1 Awards because it too uses a large sensor for imaging duties, but brings a very unique way of shooting. It takes the shutter button from the side and brings it to the back, which sits perfectly in the spot where your finger would go if your hand was resting on the back of the phone. While it does take time to focus on the subject under low light conditions it's by far one of the best shooting experiences ever and the image quality is point and shoot quality, in most situations.



CELLPHONE IMAGING: NOKIA LUMIA 1020

Price: ₹41,350